Salt Spring Centre of Yoga

Update and Needs for Board of Directors – 2022-2024

Timeline of Current State

Our Strategic Plan

The Strategic Plan lays out a road map for lots of what needs to be prioritized in terms of community, programs, etc...

Strong Community and Relationships

Excellence in Programs and Service Delivery

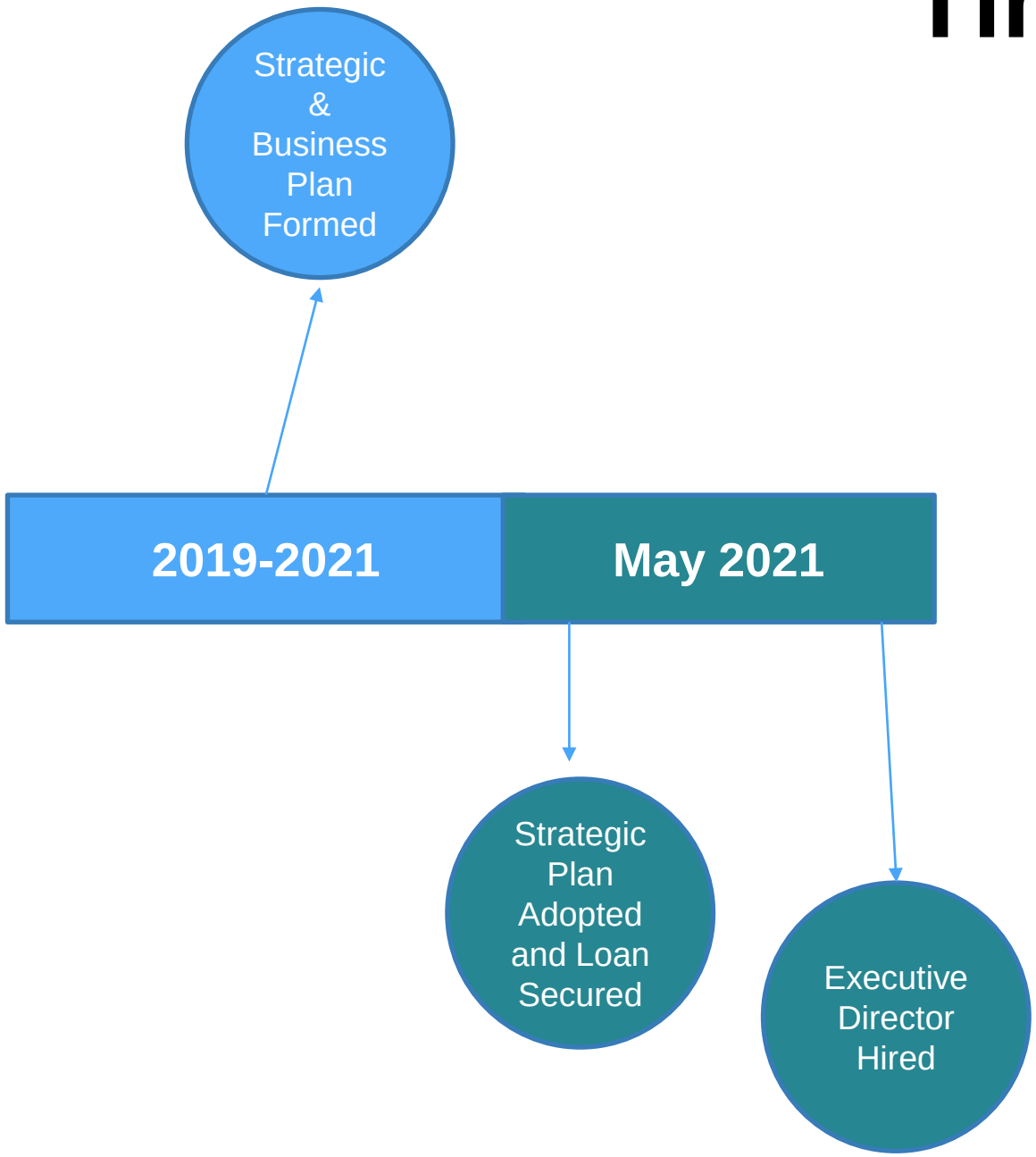
Functional Governance and Communications

Long Term Financial Sustainability

Sustainable Land Use Planning

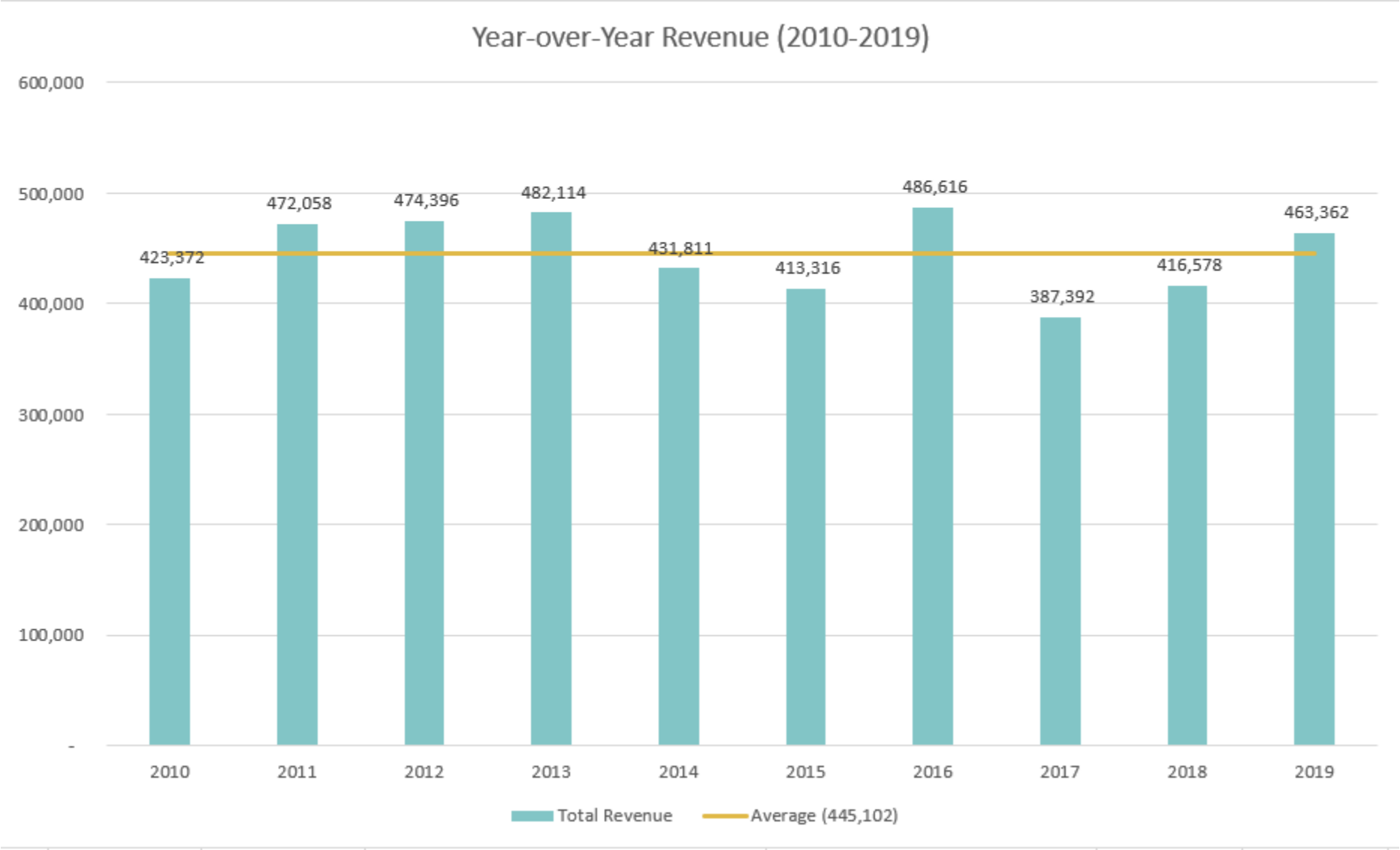
Effective Operations

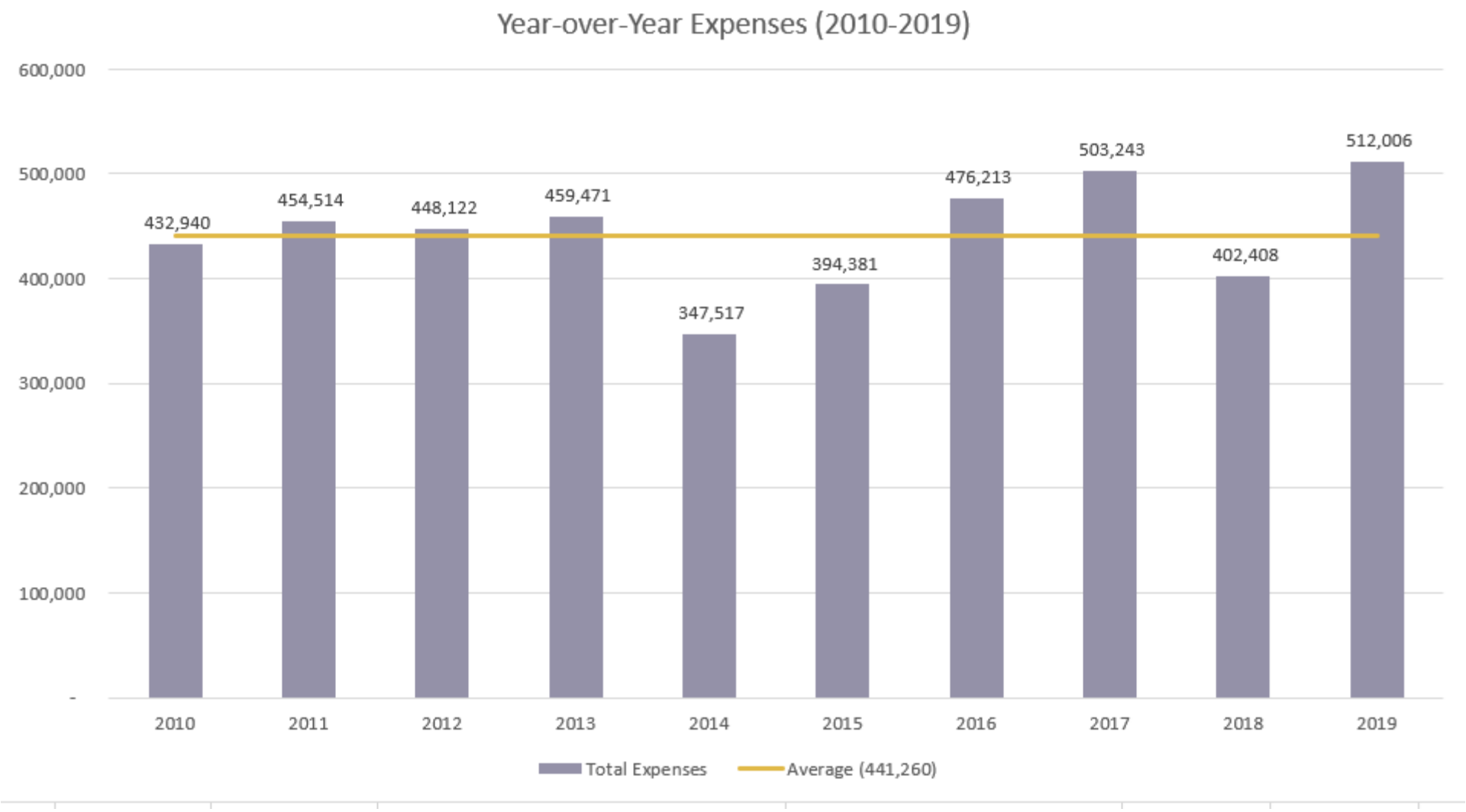
Timeline

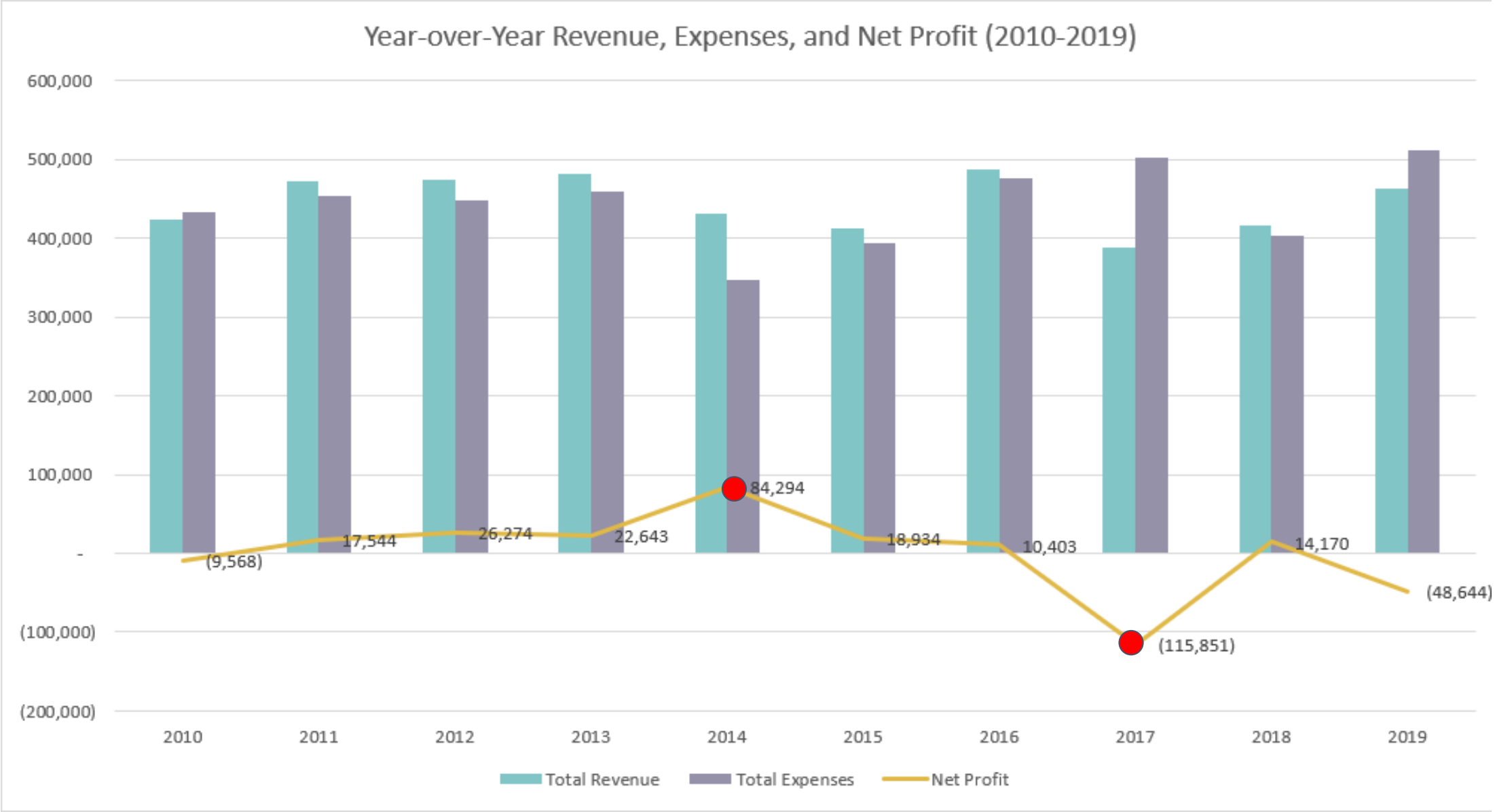

Strategic & Business Plan Formed
2019-2021
May 2021
Strategic Plan Adopted and Loan Secured
Executive Director Hired

Early ED Work

- Historical Financial Analysis – 10 years of data
- Stakeholder Interviews
- Unearthing the cultural and financial foundation of the Centre


Year-over-Year Revenue (2010-2019)
600,000
500,000
400,000
300,000
200,000
100,000
-
423,372
472,058
474,396
482,114
431,811
413,316
486,616
387,392
416,578
463,362
2010
2011
2012
2013
2014
2015
2016
2017
2018
2019
Total Revenue
Average (445,102)


Year-over-Year Expenses (2010-2019)
600,000
500,000
400,000
300,000
200,000
100,000
-
432,940
454,514
448,122
459,471
347,517
394,381
476,213
503,243
402,408
512,006
2010
2011
2012
2013
2014
2015
2016
2017
2018
2019
Total Expenses
Average (441,260)


Year-over-Year Revenue, Expenses, and Net Profit (2010-2019)
600,000
500,000
400,000
300,000
200,000
100,000
-
(100,000)
(200,000)
2010
2011
2012
2013
2014
2015
2016
2017
2018
2019
(9,568)
17,544
26,274
22,643
84,294
18,934
10,403
(115,851)
14,170
(48,644)
Total Revenue
Total Expenses
Net Profit

Big Picture Discovery

- Profits at the Centre have been nonexistent or minimal for a decade, ($2,020 on average) despite operating with staffing models that did not meet Employment Standards.

- We have never made enough profit cover market salaries for necessary positions.

- 2019 was our most successful year in 10 years for program and rental revenue – staff pushing for an increase in winter program offerings.
  - Unfortunately, the increase in revenue was not enough to make up for the increase in wages.

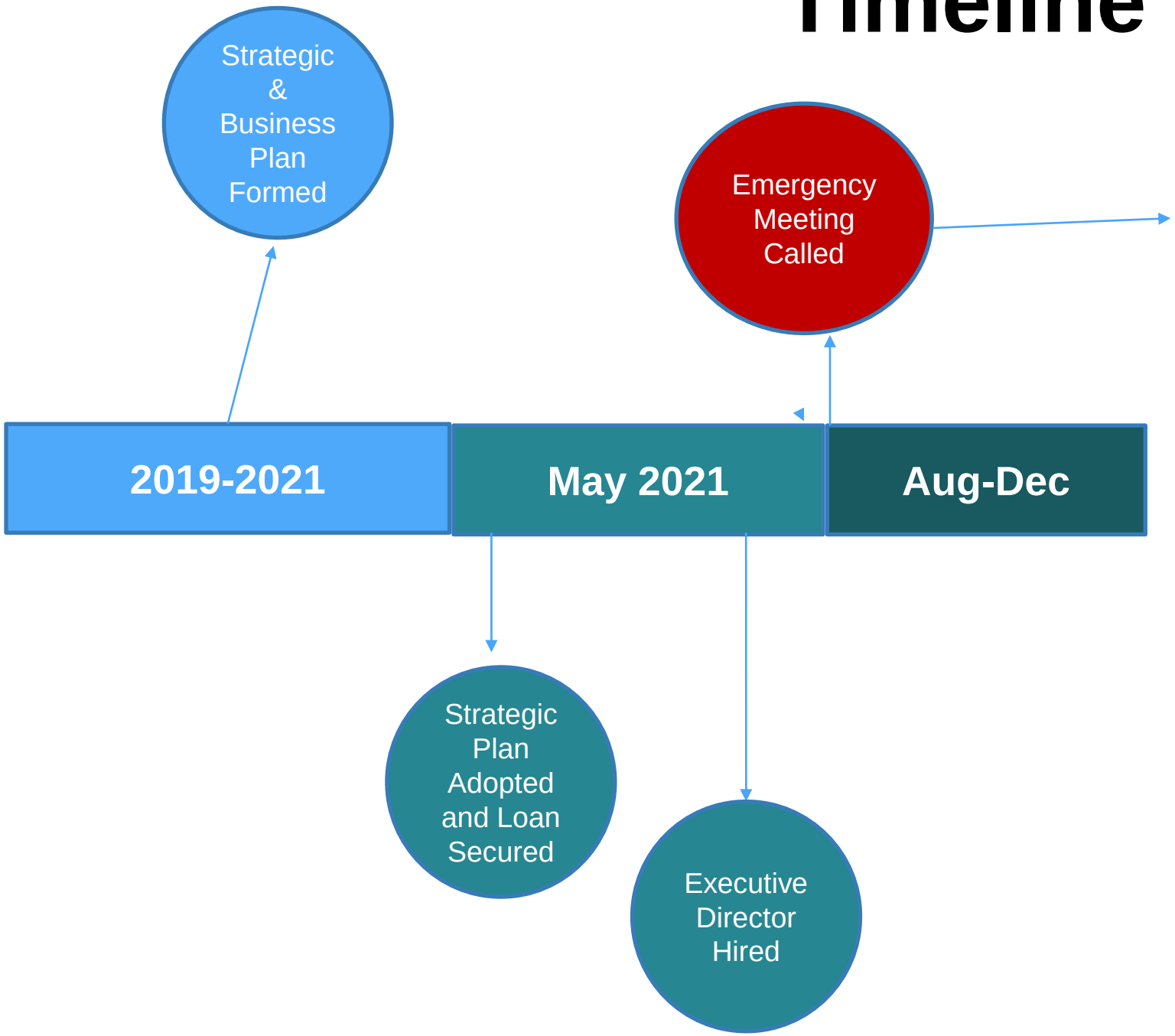
- Our current infrastructure does not support what the Centre needs to be more profitable.

Big Picture Discovery

- The investments needed to see the two strategic documents (Strategic Plan and Business Plan) through to execution was greater than was planned or budgeted for; that was exacerbated by the loss of momentum at the Centre during the pandemic.

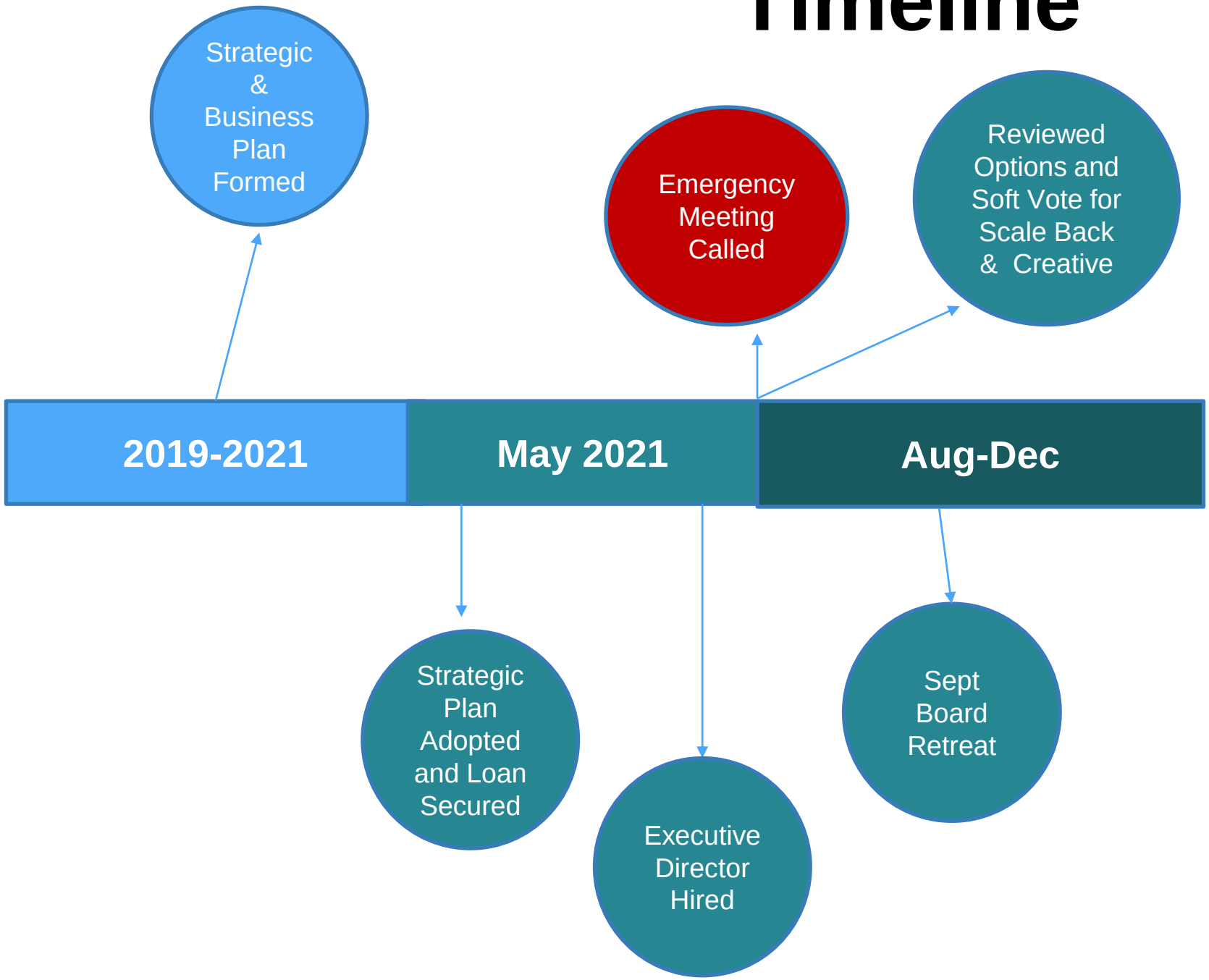
- Like a start-up, there is a cost to hiring from a stand still, pivoting core lines of business, starting net new lines of business, and stewarding deep organizational transformation

Timeline



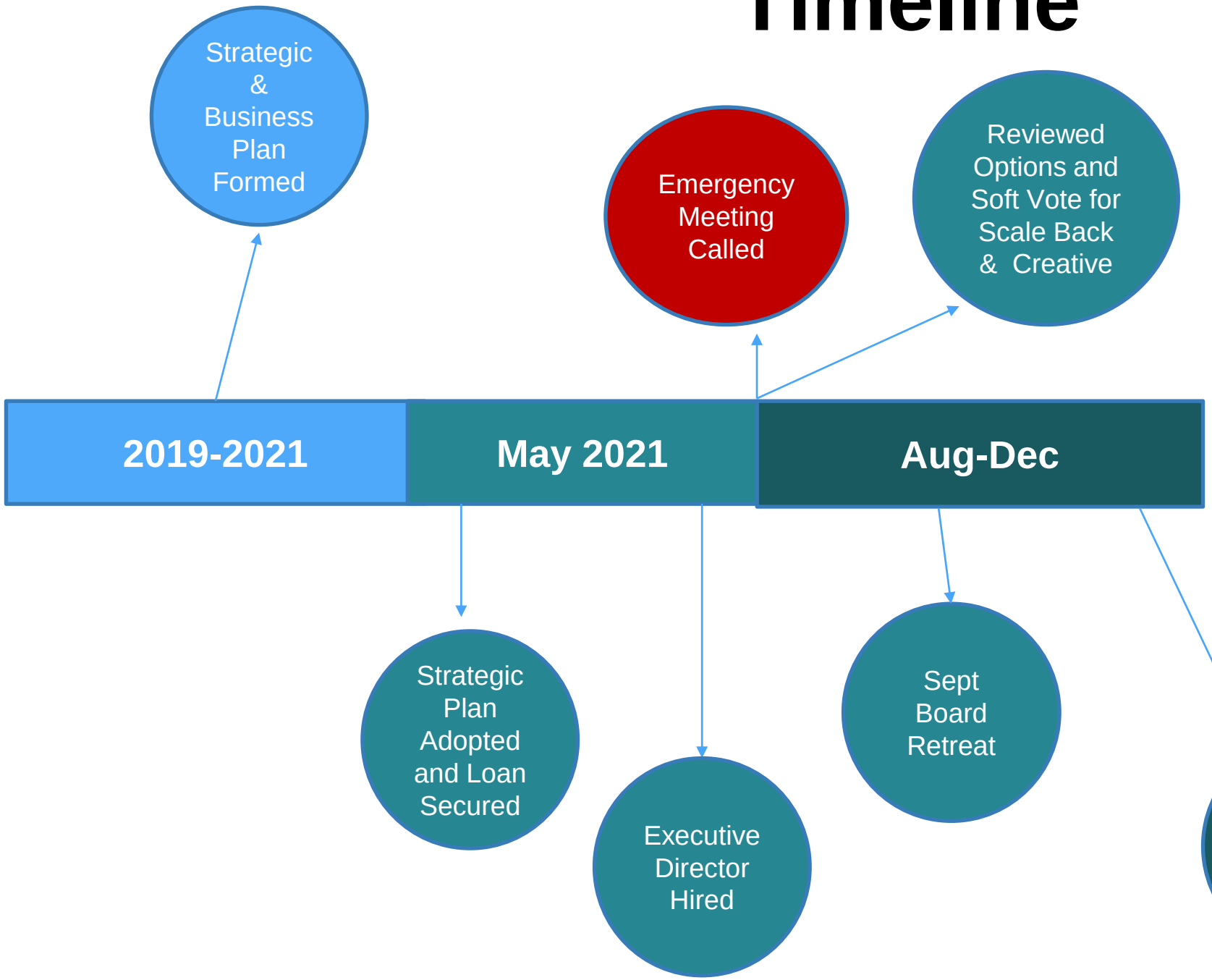
A meeting was held in August 2021 with the Board, Panchayat and onsite Centre stakeholders to review the finances and make an informed decision about how to move forward – knowing that expenses would outpace revenues.

Timeline



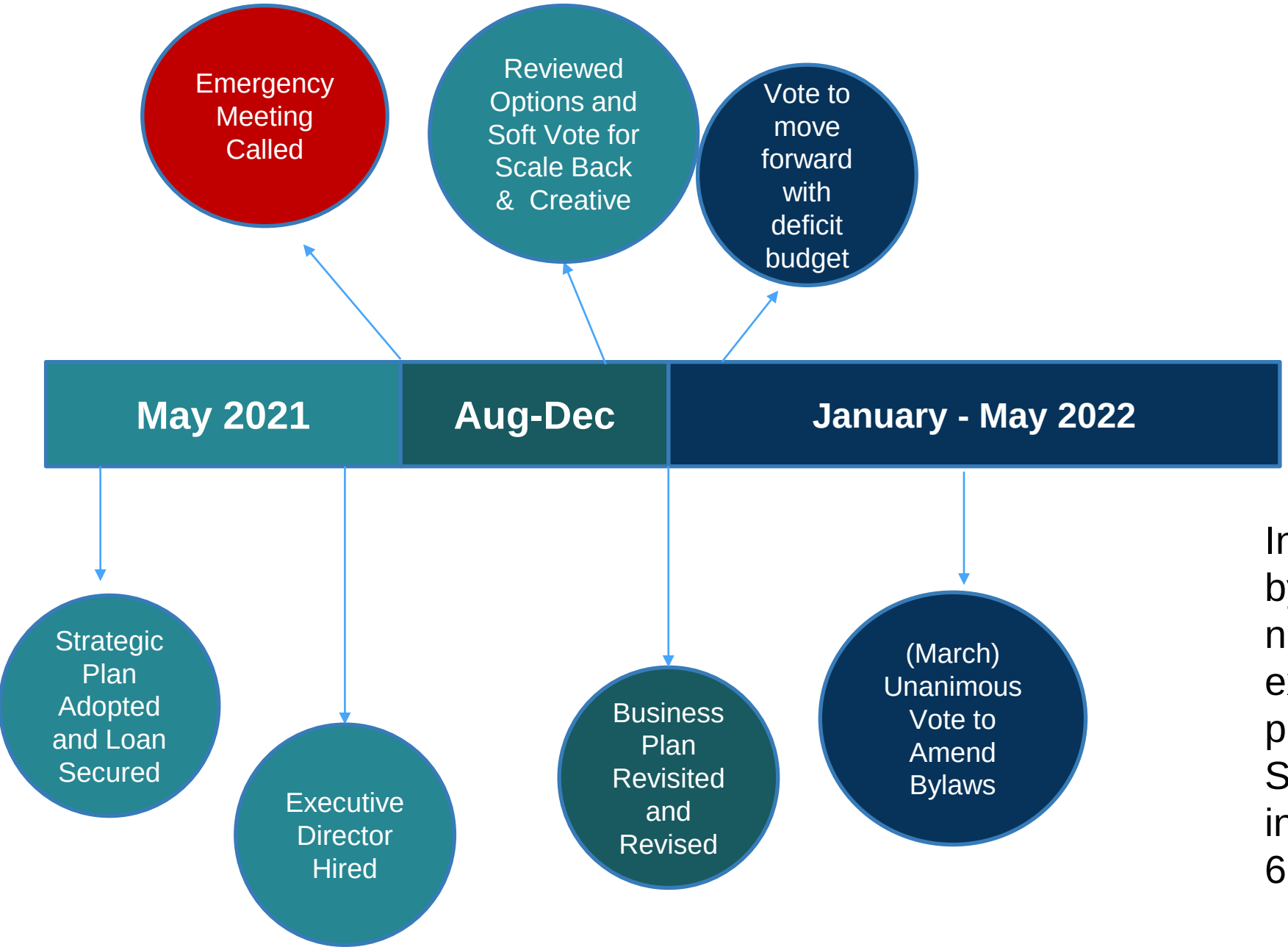
Scaling back seemed difficult to do while still offering our core lines of business. The fixed costs of running the Centre and the core positions needed to get things back up and running created a bottom-line fixed expense not conducive to a scale back.

Timeline



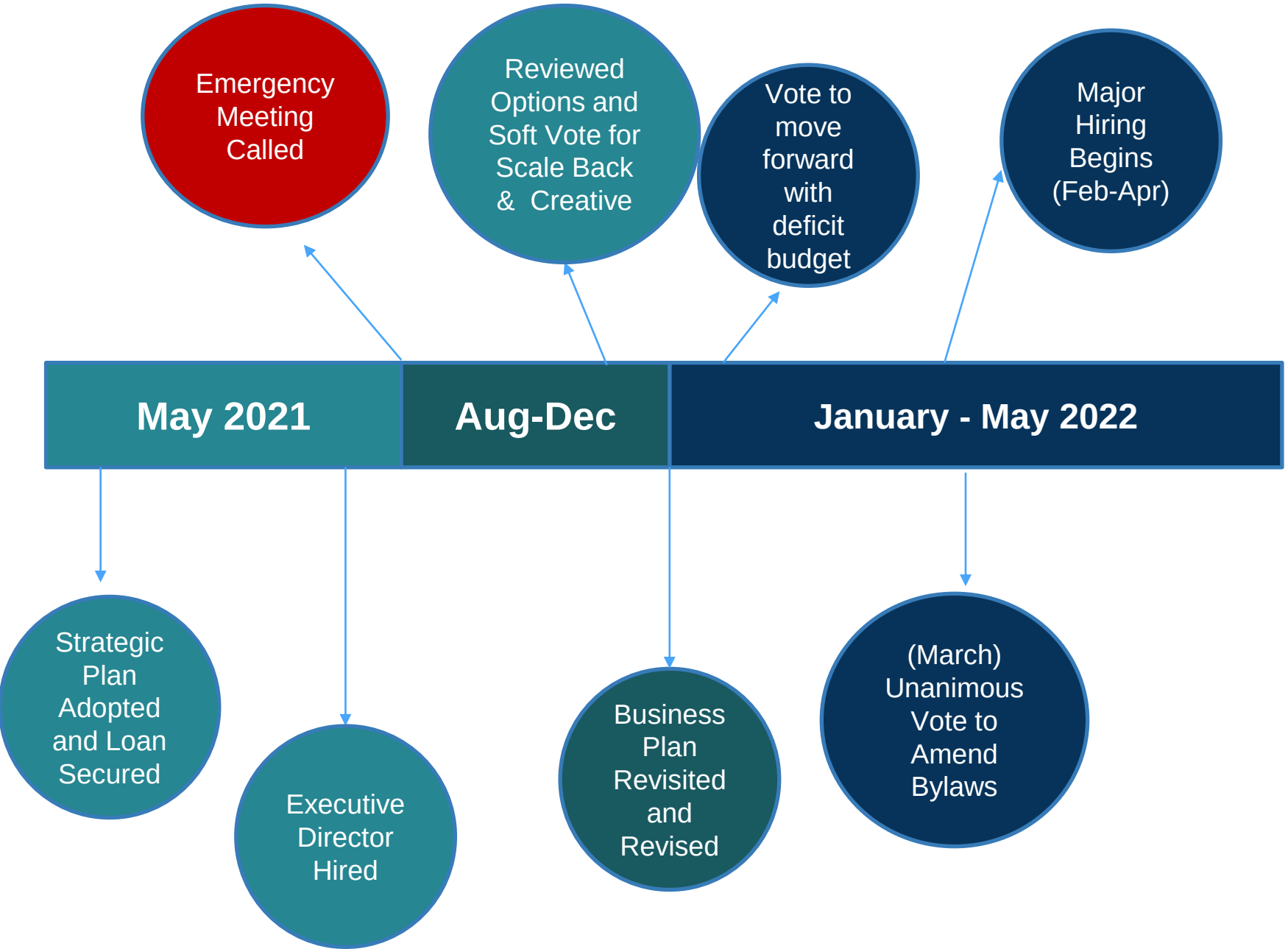
A new business plan was created that was **reliant on investment** to update and create infrastructure that would help to put the Salt Spring Centre of Yoga on the map as a more robust retreat Centre. Allowing us to simultaneously grow our external contracts as well as proprietary retreats and educational programs.

Timeline



In March, we updated our bylaws to be more in line with non-profit best practice; extending Board directorship possibility to those outside of Society Membership and increasing the Board limit from 6 directors to 13.

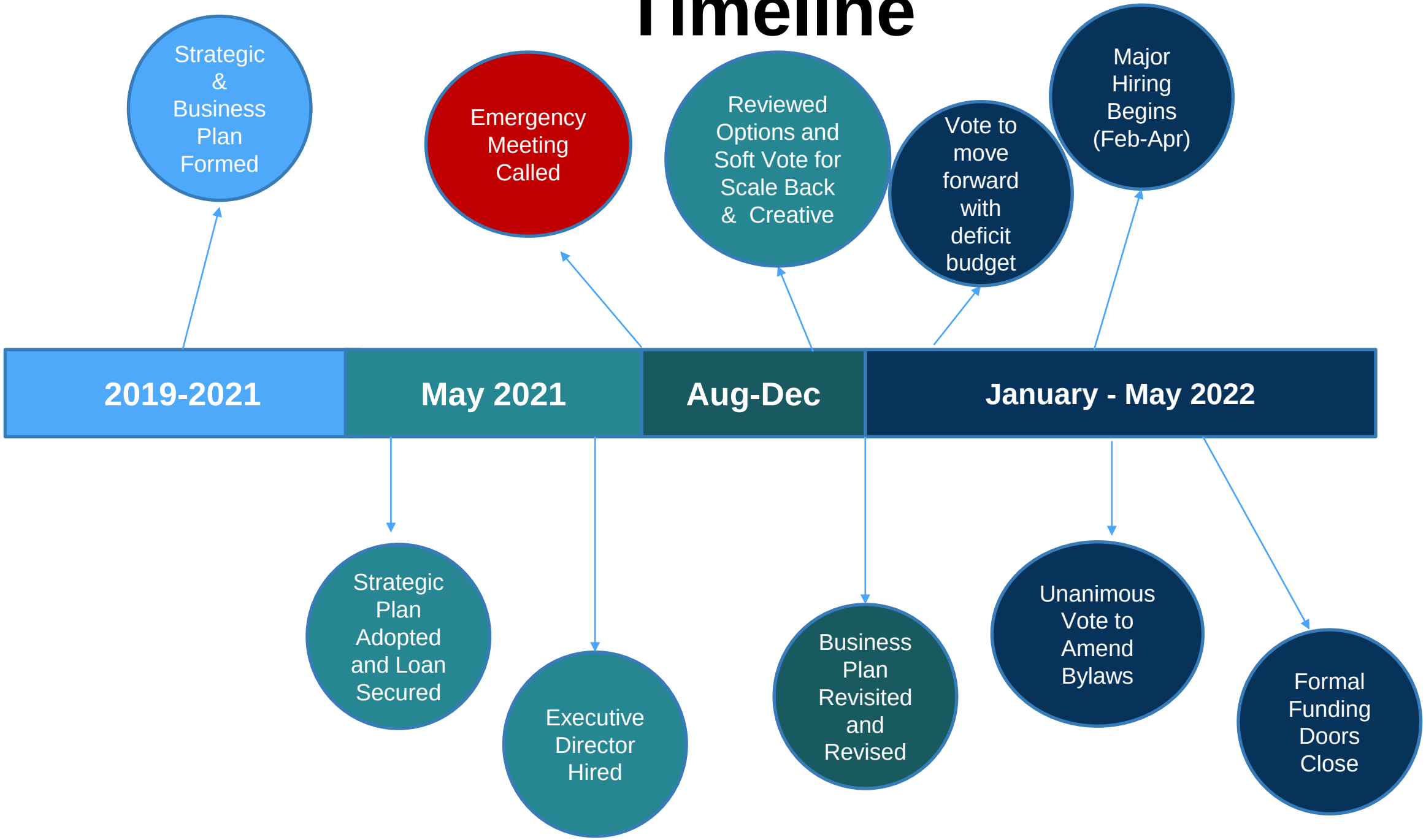
Timeline



Early conversations with lenders regarding capital upgrades were very favourable.

We needed to move quickly with hiring in order to open our doors. We were already significantly behind other Retreat Centre's and hospitality offerings.

Timeline

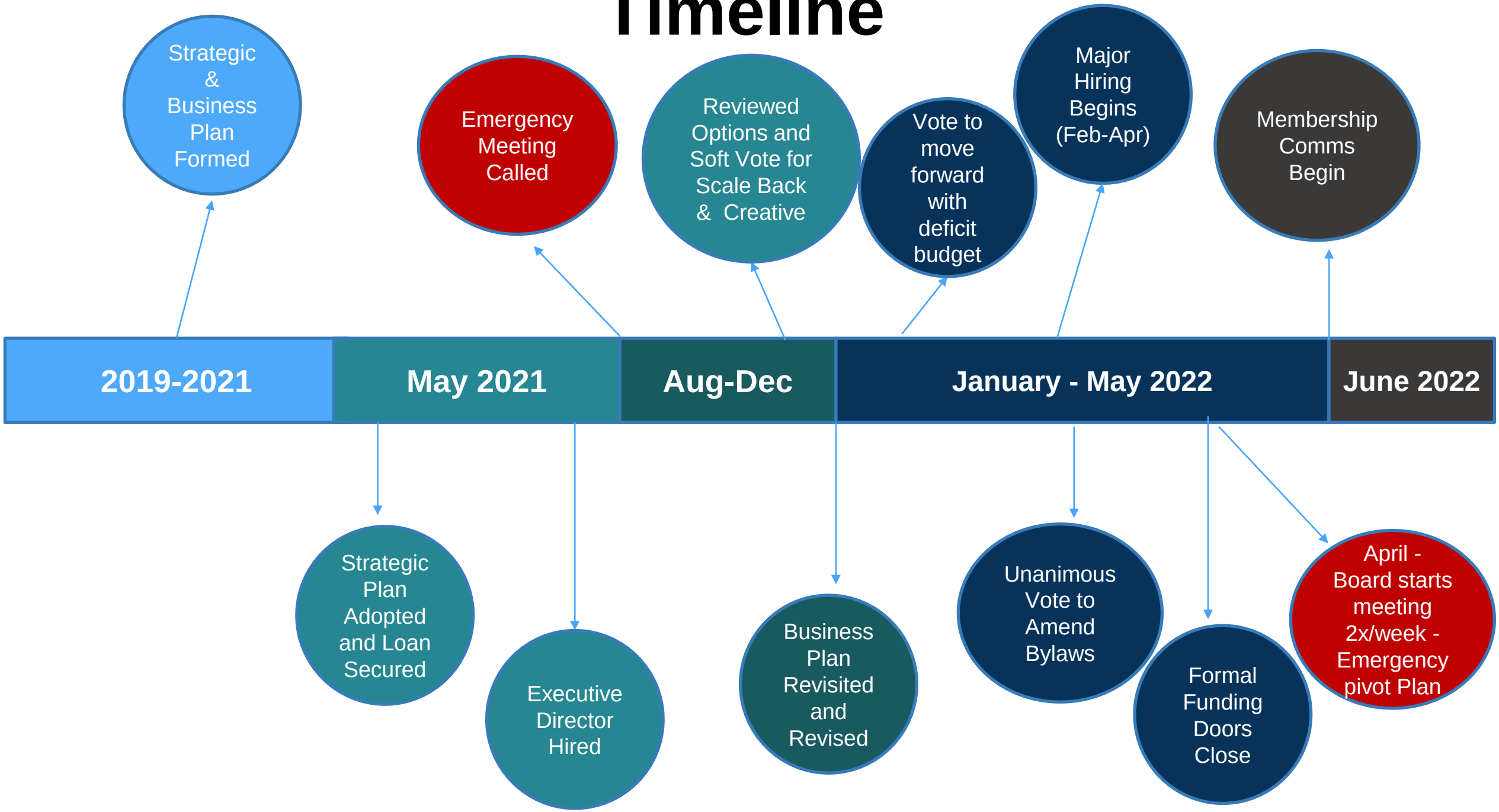

Strategic & Business Plan Formed
Emergency Meeting Called
Reviewed Options and Soft Vote for Scale Back & Creative
Vote to move forward with deficit budget
Major Hiring Begins (Feb-Apr)
2019-2021
May 2021
Aug-Dec
January - May 2022
Strategic Plan Adopted and Loan Secured
Executive Director Hired
Business Plan Revisited and Revised
Unanimous Vote to Amend Bylaws
Formal Funding Doors Close

Rapidly Changing Landscape

From even September 2021 to March 2022 there were significant changes in the general environment that started to catch up with the Centre plan

- Hiring landscape changed ***dramatically*** across industries (especially hospitality)
- YTT and YSSI struggling to gain participants
- Economic landscape shifting with inflation and risk tolerance for lending declining
- Previously supportive funding doors started closing (banks)

Timeline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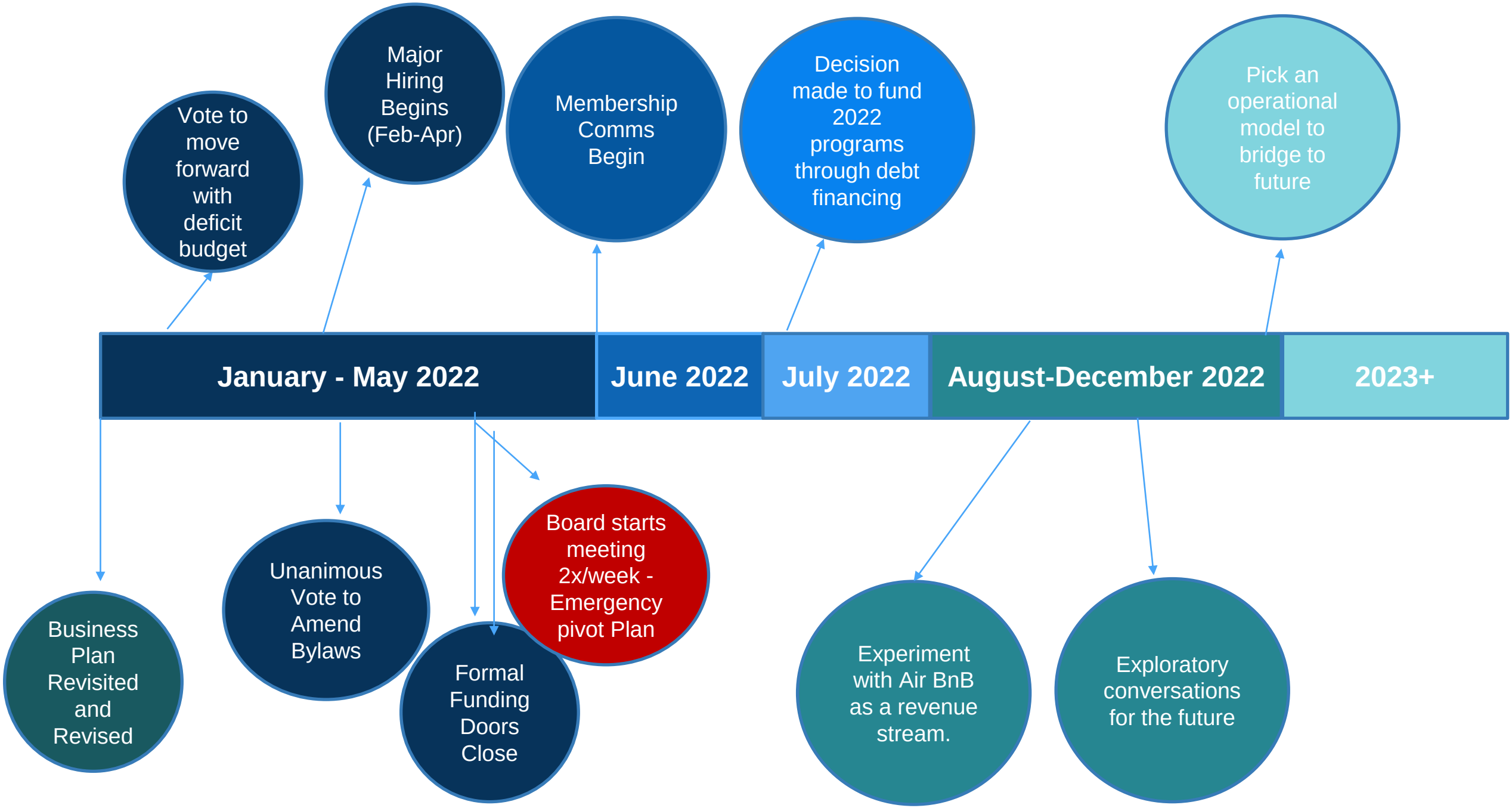
April - Board starts meeting 2x/week - Emergency pivot Plan


Vote to move forward with deficit budget
Major Hiring Begins (Feb-Apr)
Membership Comms Begin
Decision made to fund 2022 programs through debt financing
Pick an operational model to bridge to future
January - May 2022
June 2022
July 2022
August-December 2022
2023+
Business Plan Revisited and Revised
Unanimous Vote to Amend Bylaws
Formal Funding Doors Close
Board starts meeting 2x/week - Emergency pivot Plan
Experiment with Air BnB as a revenue stream.
Exploratory conversations for the future

Financial Realities

We are currently operating through a blend of incoming program revenue and debt financing in order to honour commitments to programs and to explore future possibilities.

Financial Realities

We need to continue making real-time decisions that honour the Organization’s mission/vision, lean into optimism and hope, while also responsibly planning for how to move out of the currently unsustainable financial situation.

Financial Realities

Dharma Sara Satsang Society is a registered non-profit and relies on philanthropy, like most other non-profits and charities. Many major organizations rely heavily on donations and legacy giving as significant revenue streams.

Board Leadership

- Our bylaws state that we have 4 officers – President, Vice President, Treasurer and Secretary

- We can now have a total of 13 Board members. We are currently working with 9 but will have turnover come the AGM in the fall

- We continue to seek committed, skilled members for our Board to see us through this next season of change with practice and leadership

What's Next for the Board

Continued, regular meetings to monitor financial situation and make decisions regarding what's next. Board meets 1x per week in addition to monthly public meetings.

Continue to strengthen the Board and Centre with committed, skilled folks who are able to help steward the next steps with diligence and mindfulness.

The decision has been made that it's a priority to keep the land – even if that means adjusting long standing ways of being. We will continue to flush out implications and value preservation.

Evaluating Options

Continue to meet with and evaluate potential partners and explore future possibilities. Long term leases, partnerships, tiny home village, etc.

Securing cash flow for continuous operational needs as we seek to bridge to what’s next for the Centre – aiming for financial diversification and sustainability.

Determine the next model, commit to it and do the work and due diligence to bring it to fruition.

Board Committees

If you don't have the capacity to be on the Board at this time, you could consider donating your time and skillset through participation in one of the Society's committees:

- Finance ***(now posted)***
- Fund Development
- Governance & Nominating
- Executive Personnel
- Membership
- Land
- Equity, Diversity and Inclusion
- Infrastructure, Planning and Development
- Zoning *(ad hoc)*
- Charitable Status *(ad hoc)*